Chapter 1

Communication

Contents

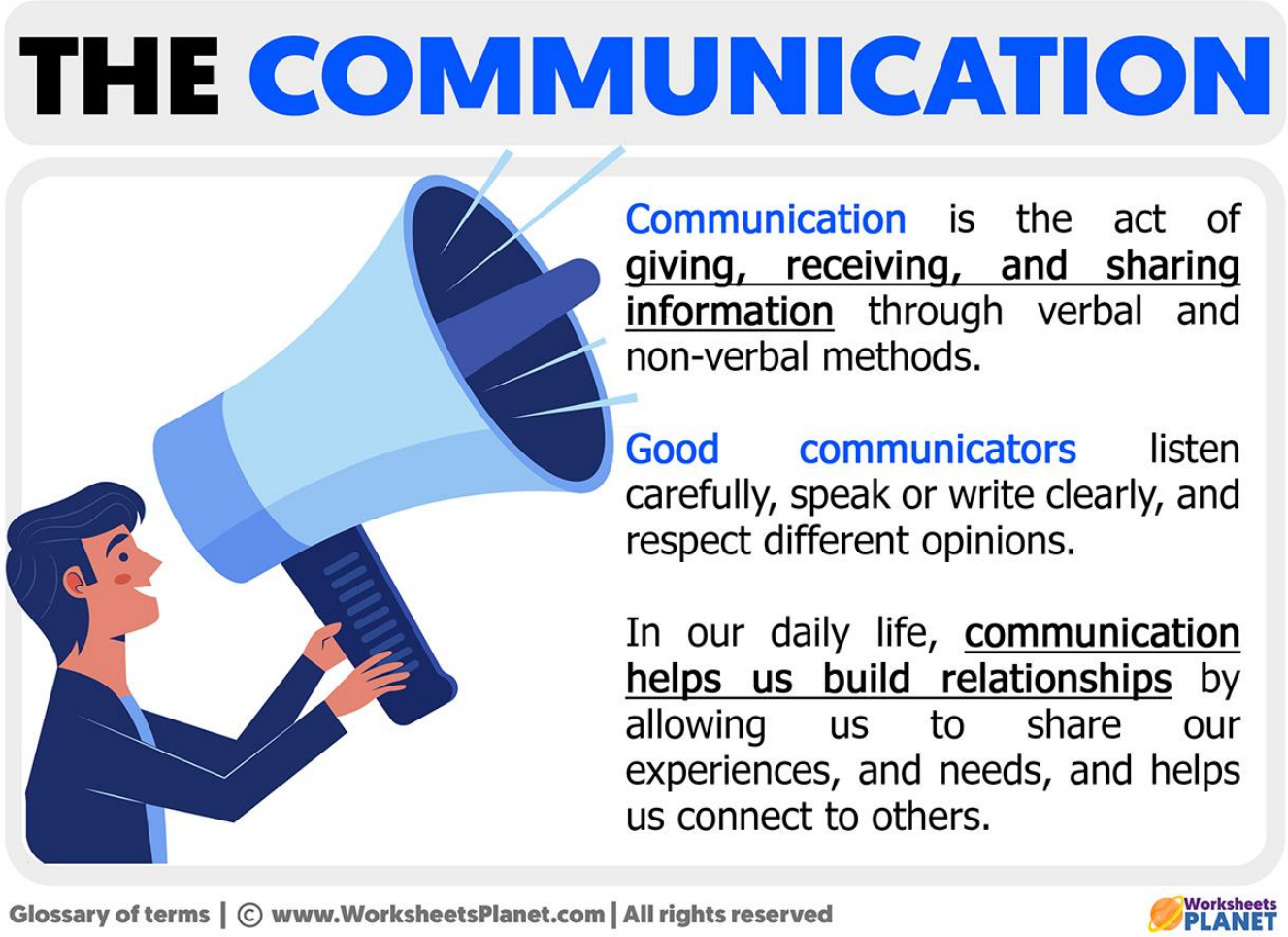
1 Definition of Communication

2 Process of Communication

3 Principles of Communication

1.1 Communication

What-is-Communication-1024x683.webp



Communication

- **Communication (from Latin *commūnicāre*, meaning "to share, impart") is the act of conveying intended meanings from one entity or group to another through the use of mutually understood signs and meaning system.**
- **Transfer of message from the sender/addressor to the receiver/addressee.**
- **Exchange of information between the addresser and addressee.**
- “Communication is an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons.”- Newman and Summer
- “Communication is the exchange of information and the transmission of meaning. It is the very essence of a social system of an organization.”- Katz and Kahn
- **”Communication is transfer of information from one person to another, whether or not it elicits confidence. But the information transferred must be understandable to the receiver.” – G.G. Brown.**
- **“Communication is the intercourse by words, letters or messages.”- Fred G. Meyer.**
- “Communication is the sum of all the things one person does; when he wants to create understanding in the mind of another. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding.” -Allen Louis

Two Schools in the Study of Communication

- **Process school:**
- Process school sees communication as the transmission of message.
- It focuses on how senders and receivers encode and decode messages, and how transmitters use channels and media.
- It emphasizes efficiency and accuracy in communication.
- Communication is seen as a process of affecting behavior or state of mind of another person.
- Communication failure happens when the effect is different or smaller than intended.

The Semiotic School:

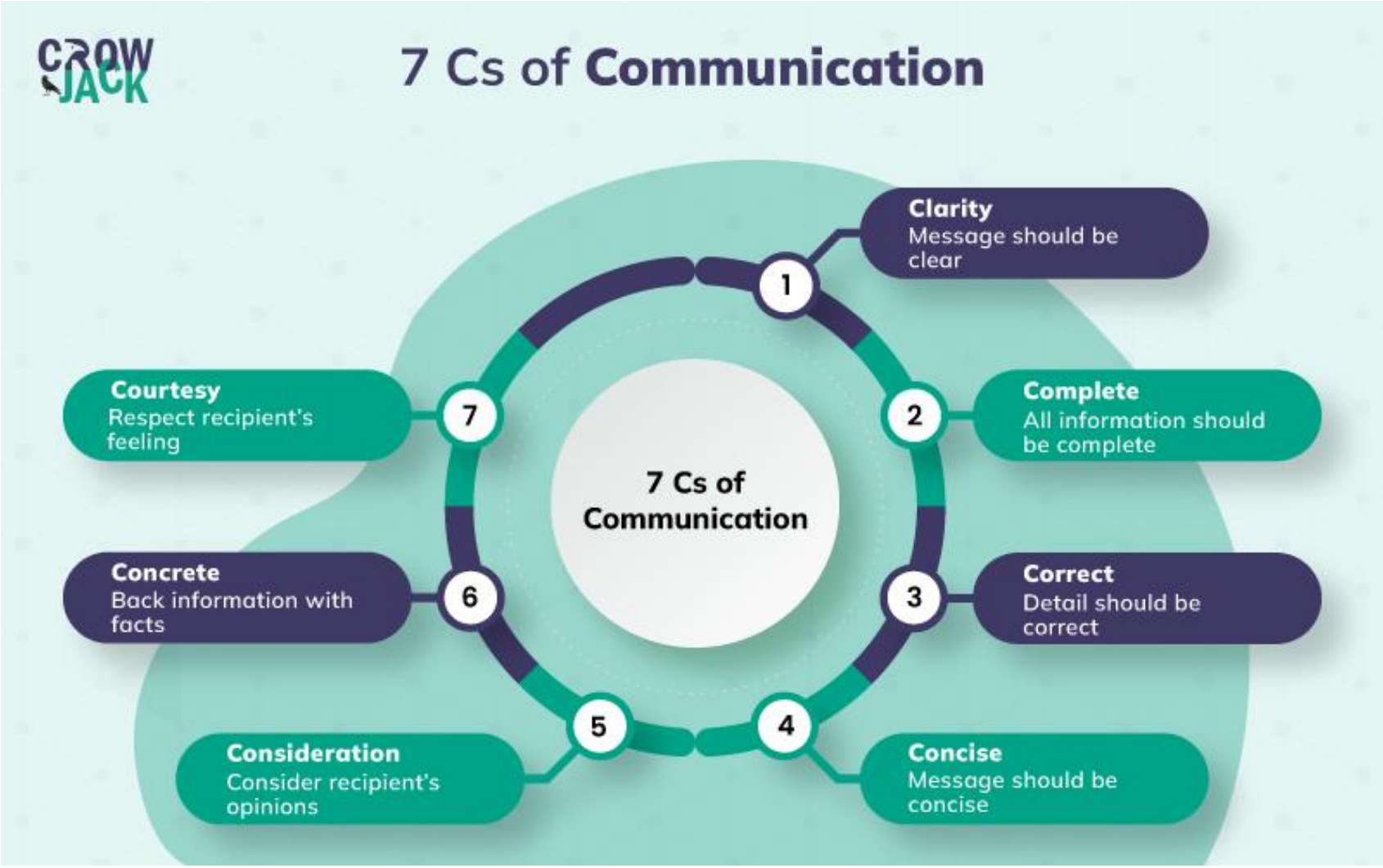
- Semiotic school: communication = production/exchange of meaning
- Concerned with how text/message interacts with people to produce meaning
- Focus on role of text in culture
- Misunderstanding due to cultural differences, not communication failure
- Communication = study of culture and text
- Message = signs interacting with receivers to give meaning
- Sender less important, emphasis on text and how it's read
- Reader brings cultural experience to interpret text
- Multiple meanings due to social/cultural differences

…

- **Communication can be verbal or non-verbal.**
- **Communication can be internal or external.**
- **Communication can take place in two people as well as in-group.**
- **Communication can involve human, machine or animals.**
- **It is a dynamic process**
- **It is the lifeblood of business.**

1.5 Principles of Communication (7 Cs)

- Clarity
- Completeness
- Conciseness
- Concreteness
- Consideration
- Correctness
- Courtesy



1. Clarity

- **Using accurate manner so that the receiver understand what is originally conveyed**
- **Difficult task (words have multiple meanings)**
- **Clarity is maintained by:**

  - using precise, familiar and easy words

  - constructing effective sentences and paragraphs

  - making easily readable and easy to grasp when spoken out

  - using visual aids like illustrations and graphics

2. Completeness

- **A complete message will have all the facts/details needed by the audience**
- **Ask 5Ws+1H or journalistic questions (who, what, where, when, why and how)**
- **Recognize receiver's needs, background, attitude and emotions**
- ***For eg, If you want to write a brochure on your beautiful mountain village to promote it as a touristic spot, you will need to provide a complete profile of the village, including its location, map, landmarks, demographics, culture, travel logistics, estimated costs etc.***

3. Conciseness

- **Using fewest words**
- **A concise message is without wordiness, awkward constructions and redundancies.**
- **Conciseness:**

  - helps to emphasize

  - make important ideas stand out

  - saves the time and resources

4. Concreteness

- **Message should be specific, definite and vivid with relevant details**
- **Concreteness is maintained by:**

  - using facts and figures

  - using image building words or phrases

  - using action verbs

5. Consideration

- **It is keeping the audience in mind.**
- **It is putting yourself in your audience's shoes, and empathizing with them, eager to address their needs, always positively and with integrity.**

6. Correctness

- **It is concerned with using:**

  - correct grammar

  - punctuation

  - spelling and other mechanics

  - proper body language

  - proper tone

  - political correctness (not using harsh language in terms of race, gender, religion etc)

  - correct facts and figures

  - sources

  - appropriate language according to the situation (formal and informal)

7. Courtesy

- **It involves showing concern for the recipient, being polite, sincere, and thankful to others**
- **It helps to win new friends**
- **It is a way to avoid annoying or hurtful expressions**
- **It is the ability to say ‘thank you’ or ‘sorry’ to the audience**

1.3 Process of Communication

- **Communication process generally includes:**

i. Sender/encoder

ii. Message

iii. Medium/channel

iv. Recipient/decoder

v. Feedback

vi. Context

i. Sender/encoder

- The person who sends the message (symbols such as speech, written words, gestures etc.) with the intended meaning.
- A sender is a source of the message
- It could be an individual/institution
- An ideal sender is one who has the abilities of a good communicator

ii. Message

- The key idea with a meaning conveyed by the sender to the receiver.
- The effectiveness of message depends on:
  - How accurate and clear it is
  - How well it suits the needs of the sender, medium and recipient

iii. Medium/channel

- **The means by which a message is conveyed to the receiver**
- **There are different channels like- letter, telephone, fax, email etc.**
- **It is determined by the nature of audience, message and the receiver.**
- **Eg: folk media like street drama, or FM radio could be more effective today to communicate a health message to the rural audience in Nepal.**

iv. Recipient/decoder

- **Individual(s) for whom the message is intended for or targeted at.**
- **An ideal recipient is one who is receptive, and has the abilities to understand the intended message.**

v. Feedback

- **It is the response by the recipient.**
- **It is the return message sent by the receiver to the sender.**
- **It can be either verbal or non-verbal.**
- **It helps to make communication a circular rather than a linear process.**
- **It helps to relate to the intended meaning of the message, or to assess its effectiveness.**
- **It helps to improve communication next time.**

vi. Context

- **A message is always communicated within a context.**
- **It could be physical, social, cultural, psychological or temporal.**
- **It could be more than one at the same time.**
- **Appropriate contexts help in the efficacy of the message.**
- **Inappropriate context serve as barrier to communication.**
- **Eg: a Pepsi-Cola advertisement on radio in Terai is more effective during summer than in the winter.**

THANK YOU